# Young-Yun Choi

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## FIELDS OF INTEREST

**Primary Fields:** Development Economics, Urban & Regional Economics
**Secondary Fields:** Economic History, Political Economy

## EDUCATION

**Ph.D. Candidate in Economics** — Expected 2027
Georgia State University, GA, U.S.
*Advisors: Alberto Chong, Tom Mroz*

**M.A., Public Policy – Magna Cum Laude** — 2019
KDI School of Public Policy and Management, Korea

**B.A., International Relations – Summa Cum Laude** — 2012
Keimyung Adams College, Keimyung University, Korea
*Four-year merit scholarship and one-year living stipend awarded upon admission*

## WORKING PAPERS

1. Information Frictions and Market Expansion: Evidence from Mobile Phone Access in North Korea *(Job Market Paper)*
2. Measuring Market Activity with AI and High-Resolution Satellite Imagery: Evidence from North Korea (with Jeasurk Yang, Sumin Lee, and Meeyoung Cha) *(Under review)*
   **Media coverage:** JoongAng Ilbo [English] [Korean] | Chosun Ilbo [English] [Korean]
3. Pay Some, Lose the Rest: Selective Incentives and Volunteer Attrition (with Alberto Chong) *(Under review)*

## WORK IN PROGRESS

1. How Does Place Shape Inequality? Long-Run Effects of Childhood Exposure to Historical Residential Regulations
2. Housing Conditions and Public Health: Evidence from Early 20th-Century U.S. Cities (with Lauren Hoehn-Velasco and James Feigenbaum)
3. Mobile Connectivity and Market Price Dispersion
4. Measurement Error in Satellite-Derived Economic Activities
5. Spatial Barriers and Economic Opportunity (with Kenji Moreno)

## RESEARCH GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

*External*

**Smith Richardson Foundation**, World Politics and Statecraft Fellowship — 2026

**Economic History Association (EHA)**, Graduate Dissertation Fellowship — 2025

**Mercatus Center, George Mason University**, Frédéric Bastiat Fellowship — 2025

**Korea Foundation for Advanced Studies (KFAS), Social Innovation Research Award** — 2026
*Funded by SK Group, one of South Korea's largest companies (PI: Jeasurk Yang)*

**Atlanta Economics Club (AEC)** — 2026

*Internal*

**Suttles Fellowship**, Georgia State University 2026
*Awarded annually to one graduate student selected across all disciplines at GSU*

**Coca-Cola Scholarship Fund**, Georgia State University 2026

**Ramsey Chair Research Grant (Data Purchase)**, Georgia State University 2025

**Center for the Economic Analysis of Risk (CEAR) Fellowship**, Georgia State University 2025

## HONORS & AWARDS

**E.D. (Jack) Dunn Fellowship Award**, Georgia State University 2024, 2025

**Outstanding Graduate Research Assistant Award**, Georgia State University 2022

**Outstanding Supervised Research Project Award**, KDI School of Public Policy and Management 2019

**Dean's List with Distinction**, KDI School of Public Policy and Management 2016 (Fall)

**Dean's List**, KDI School of Public Policy and Management 2016 (Spring)

**Merit-Based Tuition Scholarship** (All Semesters), KDI School of Public Policy and Management

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

**Instructor of Record, Principles of Macroeconomics (ECON 2105)**, Georgia State University 2024

**Guest Lecturer, Development Economics (ECON 4600)**, Georgia State University 2026
*Economic Development and Institutions; New Sources of Economic Data*

**Teaching Assistant, Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 2106)**, Georgia State University 2022–2024

**Teaching Assistant, Development Economics (ECON 4600)**, Georgia State University 2023–2026

## SERVICE

Judge (Economics), Undergraduate Research Day, Spelman College 2026

## CONFERENCES & SEMINARS (presenter†; scheduled*)

6th Southeast Exchange of Development Studies (SEEDS) Conference, Georgia Tech † 2026

Southern Economic Association (SEA) † 2025

Markets & Society Conference, Mercatus Center †

Atlanta Ph.D. Summer Symposium, Emory University †

DevSouth: Development Economics in the South Workshop

5th Southeast Exchange of Development Studies (SEEDS) Conference, Georgia Tech †

## POLICY PUBLICATIONS (in Korean*)

**Choi, Y.** (2018). Rice Prices in North Korea: A Comparative Analysis of Price Levels and Trends in North Korea and China. *KDI Review of the North Korean Economy*, vol. 20, no. 8, pp. 25–36.*

**Choi, Y.**, and Han, B. (2018). A Comparative Analysis of the First Three Inter-Korean Summits. *KDI Review of the North Korean Economy*, vol. 20, no. 5, pp. 65–79.*

**Choi, Y.** (2018). An Overview of North Korea's Economic Statistics in 2017: GDP, Trade, Exchange Rates, Rice Prices, and Grain Production. *KDI Review of the North Korean Economy*, vol. 20, no. 2, pp. 97–132.*

**Choi, Y.** (2017). A New Approach to Measuring North Korean Overseas Labor Deployment: Evidence from Labor and Visa Statistics. *KDI Review of the North Korean Economy*, vol. 19, no. 2, pp. 101–121.*

**Choi, Y.** (2017). Policy Implications of North Korea's New Year Addresses, 2013–2017. *KDI Review of the North Korean Economy*, vol. 19, no. 1, pp. 113–119.*

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**Korea Development Institute (KDI)**, Korea [link] 2016–2021
Senior Research Associate, Department of North Korean Economy Studies
- *Conducted research on the North Korean economy and inter-Korean economic relations; constructed and analyzed data (e.g., GDP, international trade, agricultural production, overseas workers, and market prices); contributed to research reports and policy recommendations.*
- *Field Visit: China*

**KDI School of Public Policy and Management**, Korea 2015–2016
Project Manager, Department of International Cooperation and Capacity Building
- *Designed and led international development and capacity-building programs with partner governments across Asia and North Africa to share Korea's economic development experience*
- *Field Visit: China*

**Rural Development Administration (RDA)**, Korea [link] 2012–2014
Project Manager, Asia Food and Agriculture Cooperation Initiative (AFACI)
- *Implemented and evaluated rural development and technical cooperation programs with government agricultural agencies across 13 Asian countries*
- *Field Visits: Thailand, Cambodia, Vietnam, and Nepal*

**UN Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)**, Thailand [link] 2011
Program Assistant (Intern), Thai Affairs Section, Regional Office for Asia and the Pacific
- *Assisted in drafting Thailand's Country Programming Framework (CPF) and supported rural development projects focused on post-flood recovery and off-season income generation*
- *Field Visits: Thailand and Cambodia*

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

Software: Stata, R, Python, ArcGIS Pro, ArcPy, QGIS, Google Earth Engine, LaTeX
Methods: Geospatial analysis, remote sensing, machine learning

## REFERENCES

**Alberto Chong** (Advisor)
Professor
Economics, Georgia State University
achong6@gsu.edu

**Tom Mroz** (Advisor)
Emeritus Professor, Ramsey Chair
Economics, Georgia State University
tmroz@gsu.edu

**Robert Gonzalez**
Associate Professor
Economics, Georgia Institute of Technology
robert.gonzalez@gatech.edu

**Lauren Hoehn-Velasco**
Assistant Professor
Economics, Georgia State University
lvelasco@gsu.edu

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Professor
Economics, Georgia State University
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